

MOHD AFSAR HUSSAIN

Complete Career Roadmap 2025–2029

Multicloud Engineer @ Cognizant → DevOps / MLOps / MAANG

Current 4.5 LPA	Target (1yr) 8–12 LPA	Target (2yr) 15–20 LPA	Final Goal MAANG / Remote
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8–12 months

Time to first big jump

2x salary

After 1st job switch

3 tracks

Parallel strategy

MAANG

Final destination

Salary Progression Path

Now 4.5 LPA

6 months 5-5.5 LPA

+1 year 8-12 LPA

+2 years 15-20 LPA

+3-4 years MAANG 25-50 LPA

Your Current Stack

Cloud	AWS (EC2, S3, IAM, VPC, CloudWatch), Microsoft Azure
DevOps	Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Ansible, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Bash
Dev	Python (AsyncIO, OOP, Pydantic), Node.js, React.js, FastAPI, MongoDB
AI/GenAI	LangChain, LangGraph, RAG Systems, Qdrant, GPT-4, Gemini, Llama 3
Education	B.Tech ECE — VNR VJIET, Hyderabad CGPA: 8.46/10

The 4-Phase Execution Plan

1

Foundation — Start Today

Month 1 (Now – Jun 2025)

Lock in the basics, plant seeds at Cognizant

Skills Track

- AWS Cloud Practitioner — Book exam date TODAY (30 days out)
- Apex Bank project — Complete Docker + K8s + GitHub Actions CI/CD
- LeetCode — 1 easy problem daily (train commute mein karo)
- LinkedIn — 2-3 posts/week (Cognizant learnings, project updates)

Cognizant Hike Track

- Manager se 1-on-1 book karo — 'I want more cloud/Ansible work'
- Appraisal date confirm karo — HR se poochho (likely Nov 2025)
- Personal doc banao — daily kaam track karo (Notion/Google Docs)
- Cognizant internal portal check karo — senior cloud roles dekhte raho

Tip: AWS Cloud Practitioner exam date book karo aaj — date fix hogi toh padhoge. Cost ~\$100. 30 din mein ho jaata hai.

2

Certifications + Visibility

Month 2–4 (Jul – Sep 2025)

AWS cert + LinkedIn 500+ + GenAI project complete

Skills Track

- AWS Cloud Practitioner — Clear exam, add to LinkedIn & resume
- AWS Solutions Architect Associate — Start immediately after CCP
- GenAI repo — Complete 1 full end-to-end RAG app or LangGraph agent
- LinkedIn — Reach 500+ connections (DevOps engineers + recruiters)

Cognizant Hike Track

- AWS cert clear karne ke baad manager ko immediately batao
- Cognizant internal job portal — cloud/DevOps senior roles apply karo
- Appraisal prep — achievements list ready karo with numbers
- Visibility badhao — volunteer for cloud-related tasks in team

Tip: Cognizant May 2025 join = November 2025 pehla review. Cert + documented achievements = 20-25% hike possible. Isse pehle ready raho.

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Job Market Mein Utro

Month 5–8 (Oct 2025 – Jan 2026)

Actively apply + appraisal leverage + DSA ramp up

Job Switch Track

- Naukri.com + LinkedIn — DevOps/Cloud Engineer roles apply karo
- Target: Product companies + MNC India offices (list page 3 mein)
- Referrals — LinkedIn connections se directly DM karo for referrals
- DSA — LeetCode Medium level shuru karo (150+ problems target)
- System Design basics — HLD/LLD concepts padhna shuru karo

Cognizant Hike Track

- November appraisal — boldly 20-25% hike maango with cert proof
- Competing offers ka leverage — bahar offer aaye to Cognizant batao
- Agar hike disappointing ho — job switch accelerate karo
- Network building — ex-Cognizant employees se connect karo LinkedIn pe

Tip: Job switch mein 60-80% salary jump ek baar mein milta hai. Jo Cognizant 5 saal ke increments mein dega, woh ek switch mein mil sakta hai.

4

Target Role Land Karo

First big salary jump + MAANG foundation

Month 9–12 (Feb – May 2026)

Skills Track

- CKA (Kubernetes Admin) ya Terraform Associate cert complete karo
- MLOps angle add karo — LangChain + DevOps combo = rare + high paying
- Portfolio cleanup — all GitHub repos clean README ke saath
- Mock interviews — Pramp / interviewing.io pe practice karo

Job Switch Target

- 1 year Cognizant experience complete (May 2026) — prime switching time
- Target 8-12 LPA — Tier 1 service companies ya Tier 2 product startups
- After landing offer — negotiate boldly (10-15% above offer ask karo)
- MAANG foundation — DSA + System Design rigorous prep shuru karo

Tip: Tera DevOps + GenAI/LLMOps combo bahut rare hai. Zyaadatar DevOps engineers GenAI nahi jaante. Ye tujhe Tier 2 product companies mein directly differentiate karega.

Target Companies — 8-12 LPA (Apply from Month 8-9)

Tier 1 — Service Companies (Easiest, low DSA)

Company	Expected CTC	DSA Level	Key Notes
Infosys (Specialist/DSE)	6–8 LPA	Easy	Internal band upgrade possible
Wipro (Senior Eng)	6–8 LPA	Easy	Cloud roles available
HCL Technologies	7–9 LPA	Easy	Good AWS/cloud practice
Capgemini	8–10 LPA	Easy-Med	Strong DevOps projects
Accenture	8–11 LPA	Easy-Med	AWS/Azure client projects
LTIMindtree	8–10 LPA	Easy-Med	Strong cloud engineering team
Tech Mahindra	7–8 LPA	Easy	Telecom cloud roles

Tier 2 — Product Companies & Funded Startups (Better pay, moderate DSA)

Company	Expected CTC	DSA Level	Key Notes
Razorpay	12–18 LPA	Medium	DevOps/SRE heavy, great culture
PhonePe	14–20 LPA	Medium	Fintech, strong cloud infra
Swiggy	12–18 LPA	Medium	Large DevOps team
Zomato	12–18 LPA	Medium	Good SRE/DevOps roles
CRED	15–20 LPA	Medium	High bar but very high pay
Zepto	12–16 LPA	Medium	Fast growing, good pay
Groww / Meesho	10–16 LPA	Medium	Fintech/ecommerce, active hiring
Postman	15–22 LPA	Medium	Cloud-heavy product

Tier 3 — MNC India Offices (Best brand value, strong pay)

Company	Expected CTC	DSA Level	Why Apply
VMware / Broadcom	14–20 LPA	Medium	Kubernetes-heavy, great for your profile
Red Hat	12–18 LPA	Medium	Open source + Cloud, perfect fit
Cisco India	12–18 LPA	Medium	Network + Cloud infra
Adobe India	15–22 LPA	Medium	SRE/DevOps roles
SAP Labs	12–18 LPA	Medium	Strong engineering culture
IBM India	8–12 LPA	Easy-Med	Cloud/DevOps heavy, easy entry
Oracle India	10–15 LPA	Medium	Cloud infra roles

DSA Plan — Kitna Karna Hai Exactly

Target	Level Needed	Problems	Timeline	Focus Topics
8-10 LPA (Service + Tier2)	Easy + some Medium	100–150	3–4 months	Arrays, Strings, HashMap, Basic Recursion, Binary Search
12-15 LPA (Product companies)	Medium	200–300	5–6 months	+ Trees, Graphs, DP basics, Sliding Window, Two Pointers
MAANG (Future goal)	Medium-Hard	400–500+	10–12 months	+ Hard DP, Advanced Graphs, System Design, Bit Manipulation

Tip: DevOps/Cloud roles mein DSA SDE roles se kam hota hai. Companies tera hands-on cloud knowledge zyada test karti hain. Coding round hoga par bahut tough nahi. Commute ke 3+3 hours mein 1-2 problems roz karo.

Certifications Roadmap — Priority Order

#	Certification	Timeline	Cost (approx)	Impact
1	AWS Cloud Practitioner	Month 1 (30 days)	~\$100 / ■8,000	Cognizant hike + resume boost
2	AWS Solutions Architect Associate	Month 3–4	~\$150 / ■12,000	8-12 LPA jobs unlock hote hain
3	Certified Kubernetes Admin (CKA)	Month 6–8	~\$395 / ■32,000	Senior DevOps roles, 15+ LPA
4	HashiCorp Terraform Associate	Month 7–9	~\$70 / ■6,000	IaC roles, MNC shortlisting
5	AWS DevOps Professional	Month 10–12	~\$300 / ■25,000	Premium DevOps roles

Suggested Weekly Schedule (Office + Commute consider karke)

Time Slot	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Train to office (~1.5 hr)	LeetCode 1 problem	LeetCode 1 problem	LeetCode 1 problem	LeetCode 1 problem	LeetCode 1 problem	—	—
Train back home (~1.5 hr)	AWS cert study	AWS cert study	Concepts revision	AWS cert study	AWS cert study	—	—
Evening (1–1.5 hr)	Project work	GenAI practice	Project work	GenAI practice	Rest / LinkedIn	Project build	Review + plan week
Weekend (3–4 hr)	—	—	—	—	—	Deep work: Apex Bank / GenAI repo	Mock test or revision

Tip: Train commute = 3 hrs/day = 15 hrs/week FREE study time. Sirf LeetCode + AWS cert = 6 months mein dono done. Headphones + phone = mobile office.

MAANG / Remote Job — Future Path (2027–2029)

Year	Stage	Salary Range	What to do
2025 (Now)	Cognizant Foundation	4.5 LPA	AWS cert, Apex Bank, daily DSA, GenAI projects
2026 (+1yr)	First Job Switch	8–12 LPA	Switch to Tier 1-2 company, CKA cert, 200+ LC problems

Year	Stage	Salary Range	What to do
2027 (+2yr)	Second Switch / Senior Role	15–20 LPA	MLOps/SRE role, System Design prep, 350+ LC problems
2028 (+3yr)	MAANG Prep Serious	20–30 LPA	400-500+ LC, Mock interviews, System Design mastery
2029 (+4yr)	MAANG / Remote US Job	25–50 LPA (\$60k-\$100k)	FAANG interview rounds, referrals, target Google/MS/Amazon

Tera unfair advantage: DevOps + GenAI/LLMOps combo bahut rare hai in 2025-26. Zyaadatar DevOps engineers GenAI nahi jaante. Ye combination tujhe product companies mein directly differentiate karega aur MLOps roles mein 20-30 LPA quickly possible hai. **Stay consistent. Ek saal baad wahi hoga jo aaj dream lag raha hai.**